before December 2018. The prototype train must be out of ICF in 2018 itself, and so we called it Train 18. It was sheer hard work from there on.

Our meetings with foreign consultants were always very interesting. A typical meeting would go on without a break from 9 a.m. to 8 p.m., which they were not so accustomed to. The Chief Design Engineer (Mechanical) S. Srinivas always ordered pizzas for lunch in the middle of technical discussions. Occasionally, a consultant would fall sick, perhaps due to overwork, but we conveniently blamed it on the change in content and pattern of meals. Invariably, those falling sick would come back cured for the meetings within a day or two; we had managed to Indianize them. Once, at one of the concluding sessions, I asked if the visitors had gone around Chennai and nearby places of interest. The poor chaps replied that for that to happen, I had to advise the CDE/M to loosen a bit and go easy. In one of the meetings, an ICF designer asked a Polish consultant during the makeshift lunch, 'Why don't you bring your girlfriend along next time to Chennai?' The Polish gentleman quipped, 'What! In this madness with you guys! You want her to leave me for good, or what.' [158]

There are many such anecdotes, most of them being of sheer hard work and determination. Train 18 was ready by October 2018 with the Prime Minister acknowledging the effort by saying, 'In the last four and a half years, we have tried to transform the condition of the Indian Railways sincerely and with a lot of hard work. Vande Bharat Express is a glimpse of that effort.' [159]

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[146] Statute Law Repeals: Twentieth Report Draft Statute Law (Repeals) Bill, The Law Commission and The Scottish Law Commission, presented to Parliament by the Lord Chancellor and Secretary of State for Justice before the Scottish Parliament in June 2015. One can read the entire report here: https://s3-eu-west-2.amazonaws.com/lawcom-prod-storage-11jsxou24uy7q/uploads/2015/06/lc357_20th_statute_law_repeals_report.pdf

[147] 'Statute Law Repeals: Twentieth Report Draft Statute Law (Repeals) Bill, The Law Commission and The Scottish Law Commission,' presented to Parliament by the Lord Chancellor and Secretary of State for Justice by Command of Her Majesty, laid before the Scottish Parliament by the Scottish Ministers in June 2015.

[148] Personal interaction

[149] Personal interview with Dr E. Sreedharan. Also, *India's Railway Man—A Biography of Dr E. Sreedharan* by Rajendra B. Aklekar, Rupa Publications, 2017

[150] Anuj Dayal, 'Professional Competency,' *25 Management Strategies for Delhi Metro Success—The Sreedharan Way* , (Chief PRO, DMRC, April 2012) p.41

[151] 'Shakuntala Railways: India's only private railway line,' *The Economic Times*, Dec 11, 2016, https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/slideshows/infrastructure/shakuntala-railways-indias-only-private-railway-line/colonial-relic/slideshow/55924730.cms

[152] 'Shakuntala's woes,' *Business Standard* , September 13, 2015, http://www.business-standard.com/article/opinion/bibek-debroy-shakuntala-s-woes-115091300746_1.html